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BiodivPond Active Contributor Meeting

Biodiversa+ BiodivPond Pilot online meeting

November 6th 2026, online



Agenda points

- Acoustic data upload
- Stakeholder pond selection
- National workshops



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Acoustic data upload

- Keep the recorders outside if you want
- Make sure the **data retrieved so far** have been all uploaded to the ERDA server by **October 30th**
- Upload the **data from your next visit** no later than **November 18th**
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Call to bat and amphibian experts

- Annotated bat and frog call are necessary to train the models
- Please reach out to your national experts and start a list – will contact them at the end of November
- If using national capacities (personnel or contracting) in 2027, these may be eligible as in-kind for the MANTIS Hub
- Provide the number of experts available for each group (amphibians and bats) by November 17th

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xeno-canto
Sharing wildlife sounds from around the world



Raven Annotate

Call to bat and amphibian experts

- Annotated sounds are scarce, especially for frogs
- High-value annotations from the devices used – preferably Wildlife Acoustics SM5BAT
- Is there need for training the annotators? Would the national experts use one in English?

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Stakeholder pond selection process draft

- 520 ponds to be sampled in 2027 by stakeholders (citizen scientists)
- Write your opinions into a shared document in the Protocols folder, please.

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The stakeholders are motivated to participate in the scheme because they will:

- acquire data on the community composition of ponds they manage, protect, or just care about;
- have the opportunity to receive training on and try a biodiversity method that is new for them and would not try otherwise.
- **Which other incentives can you think of?**

Proposed timeline

- **November 2026:** Proposal presented to the contributors. Contributor workshop to discuss the proposal in detail. Consensus on the plan reached.
- **December 2026:** One consolidated volunteer form
- **January–March 2027:** First national workshop. Training the stakeholders.
- **April–June 2027:** Sampling. All samples taken by July 30th.
- **July 2027:** Sample shipment
- **September–November 2027:** Sample analysis
- **December 2027:** Second stakeholder workshop

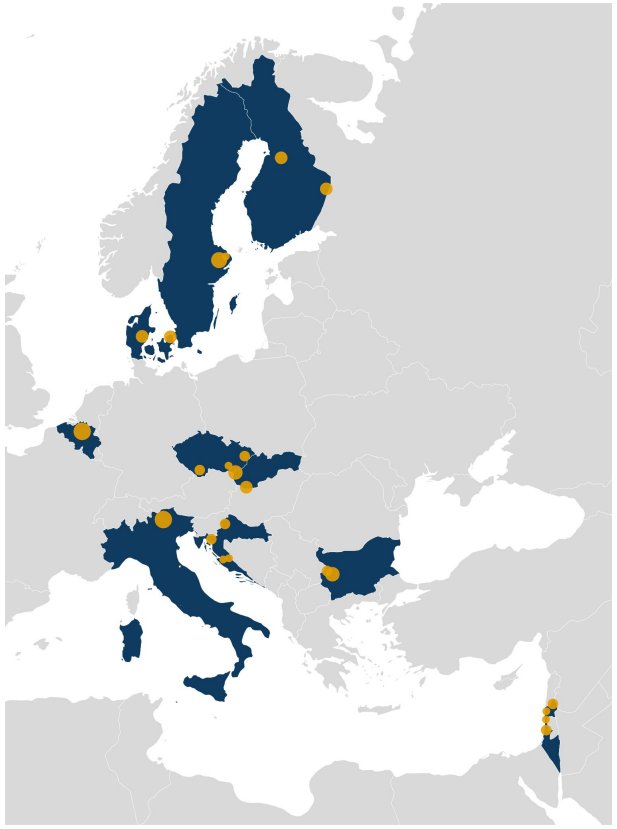
Site selection process

- **Call for stakeholders** using the contributors' existing networks and channels. Ask stakeholders to define their geographic scope.
- *Select pondscapes relevant to the stakeholders if possible*
- **Ask the stakeholders to list multiple ponds.** Each stakeholder should list at least four ponds for each pond they will sample to allow national contributors to reach a stratified dataset. Stakeholders will rate the level of perceived importance of each pond. A form will be provided for this task.
- **National coordinators select the ponds** based on the stratification criteria and the importance of the ponds perceived by the stakeholders.

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National workshops

- 6,000€ to organise **two national workshops** for the stakeholders involved in the citizen science sampling scheme
- First planned for January–March 2027
- Second during October–December 2027 – *maybe postpone to wait for the eDNA results?*



National workshops

- Exact funding model is the responsibility of each active contributor
- Shared media toolkit
- Centralise information at biodivpond.github.io
- Remember the objectives:

Establish a transnational pond monitoring network across Europe & Design and pilot a citizen science-based biodiversity monitoring scheme for ponds across Europe

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Questions on capacity

- Each active contributor is allocated 6 PMs to fullfill the active contributor duties as defined by the workplan
- Please consult the budget table in the workplan

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Co-funded by the European Union

Thank you!

To download the accompanying resource files for this presentation, please visit:

https://biodivpond.github.io/meetings.html



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